

# MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

High School Foundations | Unit 7

## Suffix -ous



Today I am learning that the suffix -ous often forms adjectives describing a quality or condition.

### 1 Learn the Meaning

The suffix -ous often forms adjectives meaning full of, having, or characterised by a quality. It is common in descriptive and academic vocabulary. Use the base or a related word to work out what quality the adjective describes.

**dangerous**

full of danger

**poisonous**

containing poison

**courageous**

showing courage

**hazardous**

involving hazard or risk

### 2 Build the Word

Add -ous to the base or related word. Build the new adjective, then write a short meaning clue.

| Base / related | Add  | New adjective | Meaning clue |
|----------------|------|---------------|--------------|
| danger         | -ous |               |              |
| poison         | -ous |               |              |
| courage        | -ous |               |              |
| hazard         | -ous |               |              |
| adventure      | -ous |               |              |

### 3 Read and Notice

During an outdoor science expedition, students crossed a mountainous reserve where several signs warned of hazardous conditions. After heavy rain, one narrow track had become dangerous because loose rocks could slide from the slope. The group also learned to recognise a poisonous plant and was told not to touch its leaves. These examples showed how -ous can create adjectives that describe a quality or condition.

Later, the students met a courageous rescue volunteer who described an adventurous training exercise in the area. One student felt nervous about crossing a high footbridge, while another was curious about a mysterious cave marked on the map. The guide explained that these adjectives describe qualities, behaviours or feelings.

Back at camp, the class compared the adjectives with related words such as danger, poison, hazard, courage, adventure and nerve. They noticed that -ous often helps form an adjective from a noun or related base. Recognising the word family made unfamiliar words easier to interpret in context.

On the final day, the team wrote short field notes using the new adjectives. They described the dangerous slope, the poisonous plant, the courageous volunteer and the mysterious cave, then matched each adjective with a related noun. This made it easier to see how the suffix changed the word's job while keeping a clear connection to meaning.



Highlight the -ous words. Underline a base or related word clue when you can, then explain what quality or condition each adjective describes.

### 4 Word Detective

Choose one -ous word from the passage and investigate its structure, related words and meaning.

a

Write an -ous word from the passage.

\_\_\_\_\_

b

What base or related word can you identify?

\_\_\_\_\_

c

What quality or condition does it describe?

\_\_\_\_\_

d

Explain how -ous contributes to the whole-word meaning.

\_\_\_\_\_

### 5 Sort the Words

Sort the -ous adjectives by the kind of meaning they express.

dangerous

poisonous

hazardous

courageous

adventurous

nervous

Risk / condition

\_\_\_\_\_

Character / feeling

\_\_\_\_\_

### 6 Use It in Writing

Complete the sentence starters.

a

A dangerous or hazardous situation is one that

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

b

Use courageous, curious or mysterious in a sentence that makes its meaning clear.

\_\_\_\_\_



#### Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises -ous as an adjective-forming suffix
- ☐ Identifies a base or related word
- ☐ Explains the quality or condition described
- ☐ Reads and uses derived adjectives accurately in context



#### Capture idea:

Find an -ous adjective in a science, history or literature text. Record the word, identify a base or related word if possible, and explain the quality it describes.